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Interview Notes

Interview 1: Student with a Tight Class Schedule

1. Think about the last time you needed food between campus activities. Walk us through your decision, from first considering food to getting your meal.

"I had 35 minutes between classes and hadn't eaten. (Behavior) I considered the campus food court and a restaurant across the street. I chose the food court because it was closer to my next classroom. (Behavior) When I arrived, the counter I wanted had a long line, so I bought a packaged sandwich." (Behavior)

2. What mattered most in that situation, and what did you compromise on?

"Time mattered most. I compromised on the meal I wanted because missing class wasn't worth it." (Opinion – Time was the most valuable thing for this student, as class took priority over time spent eating or finding food rather)

3. Show us how you usually find the information you need before choosing where to eat. At what point do you know enough to make a decision?

"For a familiar location, I usually don't look anything up. (Behavior) For somewhere unfamiliar, I check the university dining page for hours and use a map to estimate the walking distance." (Behavior)

4. Tell us about a time you could not confirm something important before leaving. How did that uncertainty affect what you did?

"Once, I didn't know whether a counter was still serving lunch. I went anyway because checking another source would have taken time, and there were other counters nearby." (Behavior)

5. Describe a specific time when the hours, menu, or food availability differed from what you expected. What happened afterward?

"I walked to a cafe that was open, but its kitchen had stopped serving food. I spent about 12 minutes getting there and back, then went to class without a meal." (Behavior)

6. Tell us about a time two sources gave you different dining information. How did you decide which one to trust?

"A maps listing showed a cafe as open, but the university page listed shorter hours. I followed the university page because I assumed it accounted for the campus schedule." (Behavior)

(Opinion: The student assumes that being a University associated page gives more “validity” to the application/page, as the university has more nuance and context of its assets and venues.)

7. What does your current method do well, and what problem would a new tool have to solve for you to change it?

“My current method is quick because I know the campus. A new tool would need to help me avoid a trip that won’t work within my break.” (Opinion: Student knows the campus therefore moving around efficiently is possible, but time optimization remains a priority.)

Key Findings: The student values time efficiency above options and appears willing to compromise food options as long as it does not affect its time schedule for classes. I think it’s important to make it so that DineCheck is reliable at letting users know if a counter is actually serving, not just that the location is open. The 12-minute wasted trip happened at a place that was technically open, and its the exact case our current slice could get wrong.

Interview 2: Student balancing budget and dietary preferences

1. Think about the last time you needed food between campus activities. Walk us through your decision, from first considering food to getting your meal.

"I had a longer break and wanted a vegetarian meal. I checked the campus menu and saw a bowl that looked suitable. (Behavior) When I arrived, it was sold out. I compared the remaining options with those at a nearby restaurant and decided to eat off campus." (Behavior)

2. What mattered most in that situation, and what did you compromise on?

"Finding a suitable, filling meal mattered most. I compromised on price and convenience because the restaurant was farther away and cost more." (Opinion: Unlike interview 1, the student here would give up time and money before giving up the ideal meal.)

3. Show us how you usually find the information you need before choosing where to eat. At what point do you know enough to make a decision?

"I check menus and compare prices. (Behavior) If the ingredients are unclear, I ask staff. I know enough to decide when I find something that meets my preferences and fits my budget." (Behavior) (Opinion)

4. Tell us about a time you could not confirm something important before leaving. How did that uncertainty affect what you did?

"I couldn't find the ingredients for a sauce on the online menu. I chose another meal because I didn't want to arrive and discover that my first choice wasn't suitable." (Behavior) (Opinion: Missing information made the student actively avoid a meal that they could have been able to eat).

5. Describe a specific time when the hours, menu, or food availability differed from what you expected. What happened afterward?

"The vegetarian bowl was listed online but sold out when I arrived. I walked to a restaurant nearby, spent about $4 more than planned, and used most of my break getting lunch." (Behavior)

6. Tell us about a time two sources gave you different dining information. How did you decide which one to trust?

"The online menu and a sign at the counter described an item differently. I asked an employee to confirm the ingredients because neither description gave me enough confidence." (Opinion: The

student did not trust either sources and went to a person instead, the staff being the source of truth in this case for the student)

7. What does your current method do well, and what problem would a new tool have to solve for you to change it?

“My current method helps me compare meals and prices. A new tool would need accurate ingredient information and current availability so I could choose a suitable meal before walking over.” (Opinion)

Key Findings: The student’s case appears to be the closest match to the idea around DineCheck, since the sold-out bowl cost them $4 and most of their break. Ingredients came up in this interview three times, and the student showed discomfort around the idea of trusting the sources blindly and preferred someone to directly confirm truths. If DineCheck shows a status without saying who updated it and when, maybe this student would trust it any more than the menu that we have available right now.

Interview 3: Student who prefers familiar routines

1. Think about the last time you needed food between campus activities. Walk us through your decision, from first considering food to getting your meal.

“After my morning class, I went to the campus cafe I usually visit. I didn’t check anything online because it was on my way. When I arrived, I looked at the display and bought coffee and a pastry.” (Behavior)

2. What mattered most in that situation, and what did you compromise on?

“Convenience mattered most. I was willing to choose from whatever was available instead of going somewhere else for a particular item.” (Opinion: Student cares more about not going out of their way than about what they eat.)

3. Show us how you usually find the information you need before choosing where to eat. At what point do you know enough to make a decision?

“For familiar places, I rely on my routine. (Behavior) For somewhere new, I use a maps app to check directions and hours. (Behavior) Knowing that it is nearby and should be open is usually enough.” (Opinion: Convenience and ease of use to get to the destination matter)

4. Tell us about a time you could not confirm something important before leaving. How did that uncertainty affect what you did?

“I wasn’t sure whether the cafe would be open during a school break. I walked past it anyway because it was already on my route, and I could get coffee elsewhere if it was closed.” (Behavior)

5. Describe a specific time when the hours, menu, or food availability differed from what you expected. What happened afterward?

“One afternoon, the cafe was open but had no pastries left. I bought coffee and ate something from my bag. It wasn’t a major inconvenience because I wasn’t looking for a specific meal.” (Opinion & Behavior: The sold out item barely mattered becasue the student had no meal particularly in mind).

6. Tell us about a time two sources gave you different dining information. How did you decide which one to trust?

“A maps listing showed normal hours, but a campus announcement showed holiday hours. I trusted the announcement because it referred to that particular date.” (Behavior & Opinion: The student trusted whichever source was more specific to the day. As a long time student here, I've gotten emails about extended or special dining hours that weren't always consistent, so this one stood out to me.)

7. What does your current method do well, and what problem would a new tool have to solve for you to change it?

“My current method takes very little effort and usually works. I would use a new tool when I wanted a specific item or needed to check unusual hours, but I probably wouldn’t check it before every visit.” (Opinion)

Key Findings: This student routine already works for them, and a sold-out item was a minor problem. The real gap was hours that change on specific dates, like breaks and holidays, where the maps app and the campus announcement disagreed. I think DineCheck's value for students like this one is on unusual days, so we shouldn't count on them checking it before every meal.